Setting up a savings product

What to decide, in what order, and what every field means. Prepared 15 October 2026.

1. First decide which of the two shapes you are selling

Every savings product on this platform is one of two shapes, and the shape decides which fields you fill in. Choose it before you touch the form.

A flexible account	The client pays in and takes money out whenever they like. One interest rate applies to whatever the balance happens to be. Malengo is one.
A fixed-term deposit	The client puts in one amount and leaves it for an agreed term. The rate comes from a grid of amount bands and terms. Ndoto is one.

They are not variations of each other. A product is one or the other, and the platform refuses a version that tries to be both.

2. The process

1. **Agree the terms with the business first, on paper. The interest rate or rate grid, the** charges, the entry ages, and -- for a flexible account -- whether a client may empty it. Changing your mind later means a new version, so it is worth settling here.
2. **Create the product. This is only its name and where it sits: a code, a name, a category, a** portfolio and a currency. No terms yet, and nothing can be sold.
3. **Publish a version. This is where the terms go. A product with no published version cannot be** sold; publishing is what puts it on the shelf.
4. **Check the version page before anyone sells it. The rate, the ages and the charges are all** shown. A figure that is wrong here is wrong on every policy sold after.
5. **Sell one and look at it. Open an underwriting case, decide it, let the policy issue, then** collect the first premium -- that payment is what opens the account. Read the account page and check the balance is what you expect.

To change terms later, publish a NEW version. Policies already sold keep the version they were sold on and are not affected -- which is the point. Never edit a live version hoping existing policies will follow.

3. The product fields (filled once, when you create it)

Product code	A short unique code you will see in reports, e.g. MALENGO-01. It cannot be reused by another product.
Product name	What people call it: Malengo Savings Plan.
Category	The kind of contract. Both savings shapes use ENDOWMENT.
Portfolio code	Which book it is accounted in. SAV for a flexible account, DEP for a fixed-term deposit. Get this wrong and publishing is refused -- the platform will not let an account product sit in the wrong book.
Default currency	TZS.

4. The version fields that every product has

Effective date	The day this version may start being sold from.
IFRS measurement model	How finance measures the contract. GMM for long contracts, PAA for short ones. Ask finance; it is an accounting choice, not a product one.
TIRA filing	The regulator's reference and approval date. Required before publishing: the platform will not put an unfiled product on sale.
Entry ages	The youngest and oldest a client may be when they take it out, e.g. 18 and 60. Checked when the case is opened, not later.
Rating table	The age bands the product can price. A client outside every band cannot be quoted, so the bands must cover the entry ages you just set.

Benefit schedule	What the contract pays on death. On a savings product this is usually the DEATH benefit on the sum assured.
Free-look days	How long a client has to change their mind and get their money back, normally 15.
Payout schedule	What is paid at the end. On a savings product put one MATURITY row with the basis ACCOUNT_VALUE and the value 100: it means the client gets the whole account. The alternatives -- a percentage of the sum assured, or a fixed amount -- are for traditional products and are wrong here.

5. Extra fields for a FLEXIBLE ACCOUNT (Malengo)

Guaranteed rate %	The yearly rate the client is promised, credited at the end of each month. It is a floor, not a fixed figure: you may declare a better rate later, never a worse one.
Minimum balance	The least that must stay in the account after a withdrawal. Set a figure and the account can never be emptied; set ZERO and the client may take every shilling. This single field is the main difference between one savings plan and another.
Contribution allocation %	The share HELD BACK from each deposit before it reaches the account. 0 means the whole deposit lands. 5 means 95 of every 100 lands.
Transfer allocation %	The same, for money transferred in from another scheme. Usually 0, because no commission is paid on money that was already somebody's savings.
Monthly policy fee	A flat amount taken at each month end, after interest is credited. Watch it on a small balance: if the fee ever eats the whole balance the account closes and the policy lapses.

These three charges are set per policy year, so you can charge more in year 1 than afterwards. One row covering 'year 1 and every year after' is fine and is what Malengo uses.

6. Extra fields for a FIXED-TERM DEPOSIT (Ndoto)

Instead of one rate there is a grid: one row for every combination of amount band and term. Ndoto's card has four bands and three terms, so twelve rows.

Minimum amount	The FLOOR of the band, not its range. A row says 'from this amount upwards'; the next row up is where it stops.
Term months	3, 6 or 12 -- Miezi 3, Miezi 6, Mwaka 1.
Rate %	The yearly rate for that amount and that term.

Mind the gaps in a printed rate card. A card reading '500,000 - 5,000,000' then '6,000,000 - 10,000,000' says nothing about 5,500,000. The platform puts an in-between amount in the HIGHER band, so each band is entered starting one cent above the band below it. If the business means the lower band instead, say so before the grid is entered.

7. Changing the interest rate after launch

On a flexible account you do not publish a new version to pay a better rate. You declare one: a rate, and the date it takes effect. Three rules protect it.

- One person proposes the rate and a DIFFERENT person approves it. Nobody can do both.
- A declared rate may never be below the guaranteed rate. That promise holds.
- It cannot take effect on or before a month that has already had interest credited. The past is closed.

8. Five things that catch people out

- The sum assured cannot be zero, even on a product that has no sum assured. The convention is to put the opening deposit there. It is a placeholder -- what the client is owed is the account,

which is why the maturity row says ACCOUNT_VALUE.

- A new version does not change existing policies, and is not supposed to.
- Interest appears at MONTH END, not on the day money is paid in. A brand-new account shows no interest until its first month closes; this is not a fault.
- Withdrawals need two people: one asks, another approves. A second withdrawal is refused while the first is still being paid.
- Entry ages are checked when the underwriting case is opened. A client who turns 61 next week is fine; one who is 61 today cannot be sold the product at all.